

Scaffold key

Draft-only front matter. Disappears at DRAFT_MODE = false and costs zero pages in the submitted document.

1 · What the coloured boxes mean

REQUIREMENT	The <i>verbatim words</i> of the solicitation or PAPPG for this section — not paraphrased. This is what you are graded against.
SOURCE · location	A pointer into an official source: what it says and where to find it. The header names the source in full and gives a section, page, or timestamp — so you never have to decode an abbreviation.
NSF-STATED PITFALL	A failure mode NSF named out loud, usually in a webinar — things the program director says they see go wrong repeatedly.
AUTHOR SUPPLIES	What <i>you</i> produce for this section. A spec, not a draft. The bot does not write these or invent the facts that go in them.

2 · The sources being cited

Paths are relative to the 2026-NSF-PESOSE/ folder. The *Key* column is the short code used inside the .typ files; it is expanded automatically in the rendered boxes above, so it should never appear on a page. If you ever see a bare key, that is a bug — decode it here.

Key	Source	Status	Where it lives
SOL	NSF 26-506 solicitation	Official — authoritative	official-pdfs/NSF 26-506_ Pathways to Enable Secure Open-Source Ecosystems (PESOSE).pdf
BUD	PESOSE website update, 9 Mar 2026 — I-Corps + budget rules	Official — web only, NOT in the solicitation PDF	notes/bot-slop/official-sources/update-2026-03-09-icorps-and-budget.md
DECK	NSF PESOSE slide deck (Florence Rabanal, Jul 2026)	Official	official-pdfs/downloaded/NSF_PESOSE_slide_deck_2026-07.pdf
DCL	Dear Colleague Letter NSF 26-015 — AI agent protocol ecosystems	Official	notes/bot-slop/official-sources/nsf26-015-dcl-ai-agent-ecosystems.md
W1	Webinar 1 — "Introduction to NSF PESOSE", 8 Jul 2026	ASR transcript + AI analysis — timestamps are into the transcript	notes/bot-slop/official-sources/2026-07-08-Introduction to NSF PESOSE program_outputs/
W2	Webinar 2 — "NSF PESOSE Q&A Discussion", 24 Jul 2026	ASR transcript + AI analysis	notes/bot-slop/official-sources/2026-07-24-NSF PESOSE Q&A Discussion Webinar_outputs/
PAPPG	NSF Proposal & Award Policies & Procedures Guide (NSF 24-1)	Official — authoritative	official-pdfs/nsf24_1-pappg-proposal-and-award-policies.pdf
OSSF	OpenSSF Best Practices criteria	Third-party, cited by the solicitation	official-pdfs/downloaded/OpenSSF_best_practices_criteria.html

Two caveats.

(a) **The webinar transcripts are machine-generated.** Speech-to-text renders “PESOSE” as PSOS, PESOS and PISOS, and “Safe-OSE” as “SafeOSC”. They are cited because they carry material found in no written NSF source, but every timestamped quote should be checked against the audio before it drives a decision. Where a webinar and the solicitation disagree, **the solicitation wins**.
(b) **The 9 Mar 2026 budget page is not in the solicitation PDF.** The 75th-percentile BLS salary caps, SOC codes, 173.33 hrs/month, 15% de minimis indirect, the \$30,000 I-Corps line and the 3–5 person team requirement exist only on that web page. Budgeting from the PDF alone produces a non-compliant budget.

On the page count. In draft mode the footer counts pages of *annotation*, not of proposal text — the scaffold currently fills the 7-page budget with requirement boxes and specs. To measure real length, set DRAFT_MODE = false: every coloured box disappears and only your prose and headings remain.

PESOSE: Track 1: [TITLE]

FreeMoCap Foundation, Inc.

Project Description — 7 page maximum · CITATION SCAFFOLD, NO PROSE

TITLE FORMAT IS A COMPLIANCE ITEM. NSF 26-506 §V.A: titles must begin with PESOSE: followed by the track, then the project title — e.g. PESOSE: Track 1: (title). If responding to DCL 26-015 (AI agent protocol ecosystems), the format becomes PESOSE / AI: Track 1: (title) instead. Decide before drafting; it is not a cosmetic choice.

1. THE PROBLEM AND THE OPEN-SOURCE PRODUCT

[budget: 1.4 pg / 840 words]

REQUIREMENT — NSF 26-506 solicitation · §V.A

All PESOSE proposals must have: (1) a pointer to the existing publicly-available open-source product being transitioned — URLs may not appear in the Project Description; use an in-line citation and a References Cited entry; (2) details on the current status of the development and testing model, methods of dissemination, user base, and contributor base; (3) a description of the problem being addressed; (4) a strong justification that makes the case that the team is qualified to conduct this work.

REQUIREMENT — NSF 26-506 solicitation · §VI.A — Track 1 criterion 1

Does the proposal present a convincing case that the OSE will address an issue of significant societal or national importance that is not currently being adequately addressed?

1.1. The domain problem

NSF-STATED PITFALL — Webinar 1 — "Introduction to NSF PESOSE", 8 Jul 2026 · @ 00:35:33

"You may have a very interesting research product, but how does this translate to the bigger picture? Why does society care about it? Why does the nation care about it?" Failing to establish societal/national importance is the *first* pitfall NSF names.

Webinar 2 — "NSF PESOSE Q&A Discussion", 24 Jul 2026 · video_summary — Ecosystem Maturity

Both tracks require a project already publicly available, with "an artifact around it," preferably under an open-source license, "oriented around meeting a societal or national need," and — critically — the "ability to articulate plans and rationale in detail, specific to the technology or domain, not just generalities."

Webinar 2 — "NSF PESOSE Q&A Discussion", 24 Jul 2026 · video_summary — Broad View of NSF

Framing warning directly relevant here: biomedical/clinical framing risks reading as an NIH submission. NSF wants "the technology itself and how it moves the field forward." Rehabilitation and clinical applications should be positioned as downstream impact of a measurement technology, not as the medical solution being funded.

AUTHOR SUPPLIES

- The societal/national need, stated so a non-specialist reviewer can see why it matters
- Evidence it is **not currently being adequately addressed** — who is excluded, at what cost
- Domain-specific detail, not general claims about open source

1.2. The open-source product and its current status

NSF 26-506 solicitation · §V.A element 2

Required content: development model, testing model, methods of dissemination, user base, contributor base.

Webinar 1 — "Introduction to NSF PESOSE", 8 Jul 2026 · @ 00:13:07

NSF's definition, repeated deliberately: an OSE is "more than just the software... more than just the code repository. It's a managed and deliberately developed community with governance, security practices, users contribution and contribution pipelines. This is not just about a technology or a product."

AUTHOR SUPPLIES

- In-line citation to the product → References Cited entry. **No URLs in this document.**
- License; distribution channels; repository and review process; release cadence
- Testing model, including any validation against research-grade ground truth (+ citation)
- User base: figures, method of counting, period
- Contributor base: total historical, currently active, bus factor
- Named user segments

1.3. The ecosystem gap

NSF-STATED PITFALL — NSF PESOSE slide deck (Florence Rabanal, Jul 2026) · slide 'What PESOSE Is (Not)'

Not for “existing well-resourced open-source communities.” The adoption evidence above must not read as evidence of being well-resourced. Adoption is the asset; resourcing is the gap. Keep the two visibly separate.

Webinar 2 — “NSF PESOSE Q&A Discussion”, 24 Jul 2026 · video_summary — **Ecosystem Maturity and Funding Tracks**

NSF presented a maturity map. Track 1 sits at the nascent end: “newer ecosystems, perhaps tools not fully self-sustaining or mature yet.” Track 2 is where “plans are in place, a more mature tool, and more mature thinking... heading towards self-sustainability.” **Positioning decision:** the proposal must place the project on that map deliberately, and the Track 1 choice must be defensible against a reviewer who thinks it belongs in Track 2.

Webinar 2 — “NSF PESOSE Q&A Discussion”, 24 Jul 2026 · video_summary — **Asset vs. Ecosystem**

“Reviewers will ask about the difference between current operations and the proposed work. The proposal must be distinctly different intellectually and in terms of broader impacts to warrant an award.”

AUTHOR SUPPLIES

- The gap between demonstrated adoption and organizational capacity
- Explicit statement of what is **different** about the proposed work vs. current operations
- Where the project sits on the maturity map and why Track 1 is the right fit

2. ECOSYSTEM DISCOVERY

[budget: 1 pg / 600 words]

REQUIREMENT — NSF 26-506 solicitation · §V.A — Track 1

Ecosystem Discovery: Define strategies to assess the need for the innovation, justify why an OSE is the right approach, and identify potential users and developers.

2.1. Strategy for assessing need

PESOSE website update, 9 Mar 2026 — I-Corps + budget rules · I-Corps for PESOSE

Mandatory for Track 1. Minimum 100 interviews. Team of 3–5. Up to \$30,000 budget. Roles: Technical Lead/community manager, Entrepreneurial Lead/team lead, Industry Mentor. EL and TL each 1 day/week on discovery interviews. Kickoff, weekly sessions, closing meeting all mandatory.

Webinar 2 — “NSF PESOSE Q&A Discussion”, 24 Jul 2026 · video_summary — **I-Corps for PSOS**

Distinguished from I-Corps for small businesses: the PESOSE variant targets **ecosystem building**, not commercialization. “Broader focus on maintainers, users, and contributors.” Syllabus is tailored accordingly. Do not describe it in customer-discovery terms.

AUTHOR SUPPLIES

- Interview sampling frame and stratification across segments
- Plan for reaching non-adopters and lapsed users, not only satisfied users
- Synthesis cadence and method — how interviews become design decisions
- Named needs-assessment deliverable

2.2. Why an open-source ecosystem is the right approach

Webinar 2 — “NSF PESOSE Q&A Discussion”, 24 Jul 2026 · video_summary — **NSF Program Differentiation**

“NSF has other programs for technology development or single software programs (assets), like infrastructure programs. PESOS does not fund pure development; it focuses on the open source ecosystem realm, including governance, maintainers, and users.”

Webinar 2 — “NSF PESOSE Q&A Discussion”, 24 Jul 2026 · video_summary — **Single Asset vs. Suite**

A single asset can qualify, but “if focusing on one asset, explain why it is sufficient for the proposed goals” and argue “for broader impacts beyond their immediate domain.”

Webinar 2 — “NSF PESOSE Q&A Discussion”, 24 Jul 2026 · video_summary — **For-Profit Collaborators**

For-profit collaboration permitted, but “the primary purpose cannot be solely making money; otherwise, focus on SBIR.”

AUTHOR SUPPLIES

- Explicit comparison against alternatives: commercial product, single lab, umbrella org
- Argument for why distributed development matches where the required expertise sits
- If framed around a single asset: why it is sufficient, and the expansion strategy

2.3. Identifying users and developers

Webinar 1 — "Introduction to NSF PESOSE", 8 Jul 2026 · @ 00:36:29

"How are you going to grow your user base? This doesn't happen passively... Very, very deliberate kinds of actions."

Webinar 2 — "NSF PESOSE Q&A Discussion", 24 Jul 2026 · video_summary — Team Size and Justification

NSF expects **quantified** growth targets with justification: "why a 10% or 5% community growth is appropriate versus a 50% growth proposed by other teams," and team size sized to match the target.

AUTHOR SUPPLIES

- Quantified adoption baseline + collection method + privacy posture
- Stakeholder segmentation map sized by segment
- Contributor funnel analysis: historical, active, attrition points, bus factor
- Numeric growth targets with justification for the specific numbers chosen

3. ORGANIZATION AND GOVERNANCE

[budget: 1.2 pg / 720 words]

REQUIREMENT — NSF 26-506 solicitation · §V.A — Track 1

Organization and Governance: Outline activities to establish governance and licensing models, development and integration processes, security and privacy safeguards, and metrics for long-term success.

REQUIREMENT — NSF 26-506 solicitation · §VI.A — Track 1 criterion 2

Does the proposal clearly describe the long-term vision for sustaining the OSE?

3.1. Governance model and organizational design

Webinar 2 — "NSF PESOSE Q&A Discussion", 24 Jul 2026 · video_summary — Key Dimensions of Sustainability

NSF's own six-dimension breakdown. Sustainability "is not solely about funding or generating revenue" — it is "the capacity to continue the effort being pursued":

1. **Meaningful problem** — attracting organizations and communities
2. **Organization** — leadership and execution of essential functions
3. **Maintainer well-being** — preventing overextension; documentation, transparency, mentoring
4. **Independent of lead institution** — building a legacy beyond the initial group
5. **Technical** — keeping assets updated with technology and ecosystem change
6. **Governance** — roles, decision-making, conflict resolution

Maintainer well-being and independence-from-lead-institution are named by NSF and appear in no written source. Address both explicitly.

Webinar 1 — "Introduction to NSF PESOSE", 8 Jul 2026 · @ 00:36:00

"How are you going to get data maintainers that want to do this, perhaps not being paid? Maybe they'll be paid something. How's that all going to work?"

AUTHOR SUPPLIES

- Candidate governance models surveyed, evaluation criteria, selected model + justification
- Draft charter/bylaws deliverable
- Written proposal/decision process; contributor→committer→maintainer ladder criteria
- Conflict resolution procedure; code of conduct with named enforcement path
- Roadmap authority: who sets priority, how competing adopter needs are arbitrated
- Explicit treatment of maintainer well-being and load distribution
- Explicit plan for independence from the lead institution

3.2. Intermediary and backbone organizations

Webinar 1 — "Introduction to NSF PESOSE", 8 Jul 2026 · @ 00:38:32 – 00:40:42

NSF's **strongest stated recommendation in the intro webinar**. "We see that oftentimes teams will go it alone... You need to get other groups involved. I want to put a plug in for these what we call intermediary or backbone organizations... their job is to sustain open source ecosystems... They're experts in the field."

Named by NSF: **The Carpentries** (community-led training in coding, data, research computing; develops local instructors); **NumFOCUS** (fiscal sponsorship, governance support, fundraising, community services — NumPy, Jupyter, pandas); **Software Freedom Conservancy** (fiscal sponsorship, legal services, license compliance, nonprofit management); **Open Source Collective** (financial infrastructure, fundraising support).

"Your submission is going to be much stronger if you reach out to these kinds of groups, rather than keeping it within your small group if you're not experienced... If you're trying to do it alone, you're probably taking the harder route and it's going to slow you down."

AUTHOR SUPPLIES

- Which intermediary organizations will be engaged, for what function, at what stage
- Whether any becomes a letter-of-collaboration writer or a formal partner

3.3. Licensing and intellectual property

NSF 26-506 solicitation · §VIA — Track 2 criterion 4

Licensing is a separately scored criterion at Track 2 (“a clear, detailed licensing approach”). Starting the audit at Track 1 is both required work and Track 2 positioning.

Webinar 2 — “NSF PESOSE Q&A Discussion”, 24 Jul 2026 · video_summary — Dependencies on Non-Open Source Software

Directly applicable given a heavy dependency stack. A product depending on licensed or non-open-source components remains eligible, but “a collaborator letter is expected, demonstrating outreach and joint effort with the entity owning the proprietary software. Lack of demonstrated collaboration or effort to work with dependencies can lead to proposal rejection.”

AUTHOR SUPPLIES

- Current license; assessment of continued fitness
- Dependency-tree license compatibility audit; count and known problem dependencies
- CLA vs. DCO decision with contributor-friction / institutional-adoption tradeoffs
- Trademark policy; contributed-code and contributed-data terms
- Identification of any non-open-source dependency + the required collaborator letter

3.4. Host structure and success metrics

AUTHOR SUPPLIES

- Evaluation of host structures: independent entity vs. fiscal sponsorship vs. umbrella
- Recommendation with reasoning and decision timeline — not carried open into Track 2
- The small set of annually reported organizational indicators (feeds §7 evaluation plan)

4. RISK ANALYSIS AND SECURITY PLAN

[budget: 0.8 pg / 480 words]

REQUIREMENT — NSF 26-506 solicitation · §V.A — Track 1

Risk Analysis/Security Plan: Identify anticipated security, safety, and privacy risks and explore mechanisms for quality assurance, secure modification and release, identity management, and chain of custody.

Webinar 2 — “NSF PESOSE Q&A Discussion”, 24 Jul 2026 · video_summary — General Importance of Security and Privacy

Applies to all tracks, not only Track 3: “Need to convince reviewers and NSF why the asset matters. Data management security plan is essential. Crucial for sensitive data, e.g., biomedical field, software, or data-related projects.”

NSF 26-506 solicitation · §V.A — recommended guidance

Solicitation names three sources directly. Cite in References Cited (no URLs in body): CISA; NSA/ESF “Securing the Software Supply Chain: Developers”; OpenSSF Best Practices criteria.

Webinar 1 — “Introduction to NSF PESOSE”, 8 Jul 2026 · @ 00:37:59

Testing infrastructure is called out for Track 1 and 2 as well: “How are you going to test that infrastructure? And then how are you going to work with the quality control and security of new content as it’s developed, as it’s added.”

AUTHOR SUPPLIES

- Threat model: technical (dependency/supply-chain, distribution, pretrained-model provenance) and socio-technical (credential concentration, maintainer overload)
- Release integrity: signing, provenance, reproducible builds, release checklist, SBOM
- Build/test infrastructure and quality control for incoming content
- Identity management: commit rights, release keys, registry and domain ownership, rotation and succession; bus factor per item
- Chain of custody for the measurement record: version, calibration state, config
- Vulnerability disclosure and response policy
- OpenSSF baseline score + documented target
- Privacy: local-first posture, what data leaves the machine, consent, applicable regimes

5. COMMUNITY BUILDING

[budget: 0.7 pg / 420 words]

REQUIREMENT — NSF 26-506 solicitation · §V.A + §VIA criterion 3

Community Building: Describe plans to engage users and developers through activities such as workshops, hackathons, competitions, and

research networks. Criterion 3: does the proposal clearly describe a recruitment strategy for new contributors to the ecosystem and for growing the userbase?

NSF-STATED PITFALL — Webinar 1 — "Introduction to NSF PESOSE", 8 Jul 2026 · @ 00:36:29

"This last piece is the recruitment strategy for your new contributors. How are you going to grow your user base? This doesn't happen passively. So how are you going to bring new contributors continuously to the system... Very, very deliberate kinds of actions." Inadequate recruitment strategy is the third pitfall NSF names.

NSF-STATED PITFALL — Webinar 1 — "Introduction to NSF PESOSE", 8 Jul 2026 · @ 00:36:29

"Be specific in your planning and evaluation. So as you write up your proposal, if you just write generically... we need you to be very, very specific." Generic planning is the fourth named pitfall.

Webinar 1 — "Introduction to NSF PESOSE", 8 Jul 2026 · @ 00:36:00

Retention framing NSF uses: "How are you going to get their attention two years down the road when this isn't the shiny new open source ecosystem? How are you going to continue to have those contributors?"

AUTHOR SUPPLIES

- Stage-by-stage pipeline design: first contribution → sustained → maintainer
- Response-time commitment on first contributions; entry-issue curation; mentorship model
- Documentation gap analysis sourced from interview + support-request evidence
- Support triage model and how load is distributed rather than concentrated
- Named events, each with target audience and stated recruitment goal
- A measurement per stage, against the \$2 funnel baseline

6. SUSTAINABILITY

[budget: 0.5 pg / 300 words]

REQUIREMENT — NSF 26-506 solicitation · §VI.A — Track 1 criterion 2

Does the proposal clearly describe the long-term vision for sustaining the OSE?

NSF-STATED PITFALL — Webinar 1 — "Introduction to NSF PESOSE", 8 Jul 2026 · @ 00:36:00

"So, what is your vision? How are you going to sustain the open source ecosystem?" Lacking a clear sustainability vision is the second pitfall NSF names.

Webinar 2 — "NSF PESOSE Q&A Discussion", 24 Jul 2026 · video_summary — Beyond Financials

"Sustainability is not solely about funding or generating revenue. It's the capacity to continue the effort being pursued." The six dimensions are enumerated in §3 — this section should carry the financial dimension and cross-reference the rest rather than duplicate.

Webinar 2 — "NSF PESOSE Q&A Discussion", 24 Jul 2026 · video_summary — International Collaboration

Constraint on any partnership-based sustainability plan: international collaborators are welcome, but "NSF award money cannot directly flow to international collaborators" — including funding travel to a workshop. Licensing software from a non-US company requires further evaluation.

PESOSE website update, 9 Mar 2026 — I-Corps + budget rules · Letters of Collaboration / facilities

If the OSE will depend on facilities infrastructure from the proposing organization or another organization after the award concludes, a letter of collaboration describing the extent and term of that provision is required.

AUTHOR SUPPLIES

- Costed model of the target-state organization at defined service levels
- Revenue paths evaluated against interview evidence on willingness to pay/contribute
- Target funding mix, proportions, transition timeline
- Paths rejected and why — including any that would compromise openness
- Facilities/infrastructure dependencies and the corresponding letter

7. MILESTONES, TIMELINE, AND EVALUATION PLAN

[budget: 0.8 pg / 480 words]

REQUIREMENT — NSF 26-506 solicitation · §VI.A — Track 1 criterion 4

Does the proposal present a specific, actionable list of milestones and evaluation plan?

NSF-STATED PITFALL — NSF PESOSE slide deck (Florence Rabanal, Jul 2026) · 'Strengthen Submission'

"Be specific in your planning and evaluation, use actionable list of milestones. These should cover all components, **beyond just the cyber technology.**"

Webinar 1 — "Introduction to NSF PESOSE", 8 Jul 2026 · @ 00:41:38

"Be very specific about what your milestones are and your evaluation plan to assess where you are and the progress of your work."

Webinar 2 — "NSF PESOSE Q&A Discussion", 24 Jul 2026 · video_summary — Team Size and Justification

Milestones should carry justified numeric targets. NSF's example of the reasoning it expects: why a 5%, 10%, or 50% community growth figure is the right one for this project, and whether the team is sized to deliver it.

AUTHOR SUPPLIES

- Quarterly milestone table over 12 months. Tables may use a smaller font.
- Per milestone: named deliverable + completion condition an external reviewer can verify
- Coverage across **all** workstreams — governance, community, security, sustainability — not only technical items
- Evaluation indicators with targets set against the §2 baseline, not in the abstract
- Suggested quarterly centers of gravity:
 1. Q1 — I-Corps kickoff; interview instrument; baseline metrics; audits initiated
 2. Q2 — bulk interviews; governance model survey; threat model draft
 3. Q3 — interviews complete + synthesized; model selected; charter + security plan drafts
 4. Q4 — cost/revenue model; host-structure recommendation; consolidated plan; I-Corps close

8. BROADER IMPACTS

[budget: 0.4 pg / 240 words]

REQUIREMENT — NSF Proposal & Award Policies & Procedures Guide (NSF 24-1) · — VERIFY BEFORE SUBMISSION

The Project Description must contain a separate section labeled "Broader Impacts." Asserted by the bot from general PAPPG structure, not a direct read of Ch. II.D.2.d. Confirm in the PAPPG PDF. A missing required labeled section is a compliance failure.

NSF 26-506 solicitation · §II — Measures of Success

"Proposals should advance one or more of the following measures of success." **Discovery and Innovation:** data sets established or expanded; start-ups created; new technologies or techniques established. **STEM Education and Workforce:** participants hired into a STEM related field. **Research Infrastructure:** new infrastructure built.

Webinar 1 — "Introduction to NSF PESOSE", 8 Jul 2026 · video_summary

NSF stresses measuring the **impact** of open-source ecosystems — discovery, innovation, STEM education — "rather than just their health." Contributor counts and download figures are health metrics; they are not by themselves impact.

Webinar 2 — "NSF PESOSE Q&A Discussion", 24 Jul 2026 · video_summary — Government-Focused Projects

Narrowness warning: a project whose only target audience is government "might be seen as too narrow." Demonstrate a broader audience.

AUTHOR SUPPLIES

- Selected measures of success from NSF's enumerated list, with per-measure evidence
- Impact claims distinguished from health metrics
- Educational/workforce dimension: current and planned adoption, student contributors
- Breadth of audience beyond any single sector

9. TEAM QUALIFICATIONS

[budget: 0.2 pg / 120 words]

REQUIREMENT — NSF 26-506 solicitation · §V.A — mandatory element 4

A strong justification that makes the case that the team is qualified to conduct this work.

Webinar 1 — "Introduction to NSF PESOSE", 8 Jul 2026 · @ 00:35:08

"...about the team, and you need a strong justification for why your team is **best positioned** to build this ecosystem."

PESOSE website update, 9 Mar 2026 — I-Corps + budget rules · I-Corps team composition

Three mandatory roles. **Technical Lead/community manager** — deep technical expertise plus decision-making authority over project direction. **Entrepreneurial Lead/team lead** — outreach coordinator; may be a graduate student, postdoc, or early-stage investigator. **Industry Mentor** — "someone with extensive experience developing OSEs and a deep understanding of how they operate." Team of 3–5 total.

Webinar 2 — "NSF PESOSE Q&A Discussion", 24 Jul 2026 · video_summary — Team Composition / Team Size

Teams may be distributed across organizations. Size must be justified against scope and growth targets, and be “appropriate for the discipline and project, not just a random number.”

AUTHOR SUPPLIES

- PI qualifications: domain expertise **and** demonstrated open-source community leadership
- Named fills for TL, EL, and IM, with the basis for each
- Justification of team size against the growth targets stated in §2
- Advisory group, if any